Some of the threats and issues to aquatic biomes are overfishing, pollution and rise in sea level.



5.3.3 Conservation

The biosphere extends from the deep ocean trenches to lush rain forests. People play an important role in maintaining the flow of energy in the biosphere. At the same time, the primary cause of today's loss of biodiversity is habitat alteration caused by human activities. The ever increasing population results in over exploitation of biological resources. This has an adverse impact on flora and fauna on earth. There are places on earth that are both biologically rich and deeply threatened. Hence it is man's duty to conserve and care for the earth and make it a better place to live in.



- A Biosphere Reserve is a special ecosystem or specialized environment with flora and fauna that require protection and nurturing. **There are 18 Biosphere Reserves in India**

Recap

- The biosphere is a thin layer on, above and beneath the earth where life exists.
- The place on earth where living organisms live and interact with one another and with their physical environment is called an ecosystem.
- The three major components of ecosystem are biotic components, abiotic components and energy flow.
- Biotic components are classified into producers, consumers and decomposers.
- The functioning of the ecosystem depends on the energy flow through various levels called trophic levels.
- The wide variety of living organisms that are found on the planet is called biodiversity.
- The extinction of such biological diversity due to human influences or nature is called loss of bio diversity.
- The geographically extensive ecosystem where living organisms are collectively found is termed as biome.
- Biomes are broadly classified as terrestrial and aquatic biomes.
- Biosphere has to be conserved, as it is considered to be an asset to planet earth.



EXERCISE

BZVFI6

I. Choose the correct answer

1. The coldest biome on Earth is
   a) Tundra b) Taiga
   c) Desert d) Oceans
2. This is the smallest unit of biosphere.
   a) Ecosystems b) Biome
   c) Environment d) None of the above
3. Nutrients are recycled in the atmosphere with the help of certain micro organisms, referred to as
   a) Producers
   b) Decomposers
   c) Consumers
   d) None of the above
4. To which climatic conditions are Xerophytic plants specifically adapted to?
   a) Saline and sandy
   b) Limited moisture availability
   c) Cold temperature
   d) Humid

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